the menstrual cycle are powerful and they affect more than just the uterus and the ovaries. They alter the metabolic rate, glucose tolerance, appetite, food intake, mood and behavior. Most girls live easily with the cyclic rhythm of the menstrual cycle, but some are afflicted with physical and emotional pain prior to menstruation, a condition called Premenstrual syndrome or PMS

Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS) is a cluster of symptoms, including both physical and emotional pain, that some girls experience prior to and during menstruation.

The menstrual cycle may affect the adolescent girl's metabolism and appetites in a cyclic fashion. Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS) is probably a diverse set of conditions with no single cause. A sound diet is part of the recommended lifestyle to reduce symptoms of PMS

A girl suffering from PMS may complain of any or all of the following symptoms: cramps and aches in the abdomen, back pain, headaches, acne, swelling of face and limbs associated with water retention, food cravings (especially for sweets), abnormal thirst, pain and lumps in the breast, diarrhea and mood swings including both nervousness and depression.



3.5.6 Acne Vulgaris

Acne is a common concern among adolescents and about 80 percent of teens experience it. The main culprit of acne is over activity of sebaceous glands in the skin. Blockage in a duct in the gland can lead to infection and localized pressure resulting in an acne lesion. Adolescents are warned to avoid junk foods like nuts, chocolates, pizzas, chips, candies and ice creams to prevent acne.

Acne

Chronic inflammation of the skin's follicles and oil-producing glands, which leads to an accumulation of oils inside the ducts that surround hairs; usually associated with maturation of young adults



3.5.7 Malnutrition due to teenage pregnancy

Teenage mothers are considered to be at high risk as maternal death and infant mortality rates are higher among them. The biological immaturity has a greater impact on pregnancy. Malnutrition sets in when the pregnant adolescent girl fails to meet the demands of not only her growth but also that of the foetus. This has a direct bearing

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